

Understanding Swastha Vritta

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INTRODUCTION

- ❑ **Swastha vritta** is a branch of Ayurveda that focuses on preventing disease and maintaining health through a holistic approach.
- A healthy diet is a key part of **Swastha vritta**.
- Practising good hygiene is important for **Swastha vritta**.
- Yoga is a key part of **Swastha vritta**.
- Lifestyle changes.
- ❑ **Swastha vritta** is a branch of Ayurveda that deals with the prevention methods to lead a healthy life. It is a science of health that includes the practice of maintenance of public health.
- ❑ Ayurveda defines and acknowledges how to live a healthy life. It is not limited to the treatment with herbs but it is a way of life that describes the diet, healthy diet, routine, behaviour, and rules that are beneficial to live a healthy life.

ROLE OF SWASTHA VRITTA IN AYURVEDA

- In Ayurveda, Swasthavritta defines the prevention of diseases through a healthy lifestyle, diet, yoga and much more. Swasthavritta focuses on preserving the health of a healthy person and curing the disease of the diseased person.
 - Swasthavritta plays an important role as it teaches us the healthy lifestyle regimens to be healthy both mentally and physically.
1. **DINACHARYA** : Dinacharya means daily routine which is to be followed to remain healthy. It defines daily routine for a healthy state of mind and body such as :
 - ✓ **Pratautthanam** : In Ayurveda, it means getting up early creates a healthy, alert, focused and peaceful mind.
 - ✓ **Ushapana** : AKA as Achaman in Ayurveda . After waking up Ayurveda states that washing hands and feet and drinking luke warm water or normal water preferably in a clay or copper vessel is beneficial. The benefits of drinking water early in the morning help to improve digestion, help to pass urine and pass the stool easily, and minimize the risk of disease in the digestive system .

Malamutra Visarhan : Voiding natural urges in the morning is best to maintain a healthy body. As this helps to maintain gut health and prevent disease.

Dantadhavan : After excretion, the cleaning of teeth and tongue is vital. Teeth should be cleaned properly with herbs, and bitter plants like neem or fine powder of neem ; Triphala etc . Cleaning the tongue is another vital step in the cleaning process. With a curve scraper , the tongue should be cleaned properly. This process helps to remove the filth and bacteria from the mouth and keeps you fresh. After cleaning teeth and tongue , gargling with lukewarm water with salts keeps gum, mouth and throat healthy.

Nasyakarm : Nasal medication is the next step. Cleaning the nostrils passage is done by applying 35 drops of ghee or sesame oil in each nostril in the morning. Cleaning the nose helps to prevent headaches, sinusitis, skin complaints and many more.

Abhyangam : It means oil massage . Oil massage therapy is an essential part of ayurveda. Here, massage oil to the whole body is necessary, particularly on the head, ears, and feet with oil such as mustard, sesame, and coconut oil. This helps increase blood circulation, softens skin, strengthen muscles , and enhance the quality of sleep. Massaging your feet before going to bed at night improves eyesight , fatigue , and stiffness of your feet.

Vyayama : Refers to yoga and exercise that is to be done regularly to remain healthy. Physical activity such as yoga asana and pranayama helps to increase blood circulation and resistance against disease. The exercise improves digestion, and organ health and improves memory. If one cannot do yoga at least one should walk.

Kshaur Karma : It refers to the cutting of hair and nails. Cutting of nails , hair, or shaving should be done a maximum of once in a week. This helps to maintain hygiene and remain body – light and fresh.

Snana : Snana means bathing. Bathing in the morning helps to maintain hygiene i.e removes sweat and exhaustion. Bathing with cold or warm water improves digestion, muscle strength and skin health.

Dhyanam : A few minutes of meditation will help to have a peaceful mind. Sitting quietly in a quiet place provides you peace and self awareness. Makes you calm , stress – free, and relaxed all day long.

2. **DIETARY** : Diet plays a vital role to maintain a healthy life or healthy body. As food is a part of our daily life then it is important to choose what is right to eat. Eating at the right time and the right food that is properly cooked helps to improve digestion.
3. **RATRICHARYA** : it explains the routine at night in Ayurveda as :
 - ✓ Dinner (Ratribhojan) should be eaten 3 to 4 hours before sleep . Dinner should be lighter and consumed in a warm state and fresh. Curd should be avoided at night . Take a slow walk after having your food.
 - ✓ Sleep (Nindra) The sleep should be a maximum of 8 hours. The quality of sleep is necessary to make your mind healthy and relaxed, Sleeping late at night should be avoided. Ayurveda before going to sleep on should massage their head and feet with oil.
4. **RASAYANA** : they are used to cure diseases and to prevent the body from having diseases. Rasayana improves immunity and performs important functions in the body. It helps to recover the body's health.